CYBERCAB FLEET OWNERS · PUBLIC EDITION

Charging & Depot Hubs

How to size , build , staff and finance a hub that charges , cleans and parks robotaxis

Version 1.0 · Oct 31, 2026

Written by an expert of the Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners community , based on a real hub financial model built with MAKE and Partners (September 2024)

cybercabfleetowners.com

Independent community, not affiliated with Tesla, Inc.

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Where this comes from
This guide is based on a real hub financial model built with MAKE and Partners (September 2024) , for a robotaxi hub in a warehouse about 10 km from a city centre , plus notes from the model builders . Items marked (assumption) are model inputs , not measured facts .

Before you read
Not financial advice . Figures come from one hub model ; they are planning assumptions , not quotes or forecasts . Amounts are in the model currency (the model mixes euro and dollar sources) . This edition contains costs only : no revenue , earnings , margin or return figures .

CHAPTER 1

What a hub is

A pit box for robotaxis

A robotaxi is no use to anyone while it waits for a plug , a clean or a parking spot . A hub is where it gets all three , fast .

> **What a hub does**
> Charging · Cleaning · Parking for redundant cars in down times

In the model builders' notes , hubs provide charging and cleaning while robotaxis are live . Superchargers are included because , per Cern Basher's model , each car needs charging on average at least once a day . During down times , redundant cars need somewhere to park .

> **Who does what**
> The network operator : software , dispatch , remote help , updates · Third parties : charging , cleaning , tyres and minor repairs , customer support

The model assumes the network operator keeps control of the car software , dispatch and over-the-air updates , while hubs from third parties fill the physical gaps : charging where the operator's own network is thin , routine maintenance , specialised cleaning and outsourced customer service .

~200 cars a day

The model builders' first estimate for an average 3,000 m2 site at 40% fleet utilisation (assumption)

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CHAPTER 2

Sizing a hub

The three assumptions that drive everything

Change one number , the utilisation rate , and the chargers , the space and the staff all move with it .

The most important assumptions
Cars per m2 · Expected fleet utilisation · Staffing to keep the hub running

The model builders name these three as the assumptions that matter most . Change the utilisation or the number of cars served per day , and the model's costs and the hardware needed change with it .

How chargers are sized
40 minutes per charge (assumption) · Chargers available 24 hours a day (assumption) · So one supercharger handles about 36 charges a day

The model divides the charges needed per day by what one charger can deliver in 24 hours . At about one charge per car per day , that gives the table below . The model's base case is 375 cars and 11 superchargers ; the builders' first estimate is about 200 cars and about 6 superchargers .

Cars served per day	Superchargers (1 charge per car , 40 min , 24/7)	Cars parked at once (half , assumption)	Parking area at 12 m2 per parked car
100	3	50	600 m2
200	6	100	1,200 m2
375	11	187	2,244 m2
500	14	250	3,000 m2

How utilisation changes the load
A car at 100% could drive about 584 km a day in the model · 15 kWh per 100 km (assumption)

Higher utilisation means more kilometres , more energy per car and more charging time per car , but also fewer idle cars to park . Lower utilisation means more parking and fewer charges . The table shows the model's driving and energy per car per day .

Fleet utilisation	km per car per day	kWh per car per day
30%	175.1	26.3
35%	204.3	30.6
40%	233.5	35.0
45%	262.7	39.4
50%	291.9	43.8

Destination chargers
May reduce supercharger needs · Add complexity

Slower destination chargers at parking spots can cut the number of superchargers needed , but add cable handling , car moves and scheduling . The model does not include them , so treat this as an option to test .

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CHAPTER 3

Layout and site

3,000 m2 in a warehouse near the city

The model puts the hub in a warehouse about 10 km from the city centre : close enough for short empty trips , cheap enough to rent .

Area	m2 in the base model
Office	100
Service area (charging , cleaning)	650
Parking lot	2,250
Total	3,000

Layout rules from the model
Space each charger for easy car moves · Cooling and fire suppression near chargers · Cable retractors , heavy-duty cables , 10 to 20% spare · Fencing , gate , lighting , 15 CCTV cameras

Plan the charging bays where cars can enter and leave without blocking each other , with ventilation and an emergency shutdown . The parking lot assumes only half of the cars served per day are parked at the same time (assumption) .

Optional energy
Solar roof 0.5 MW · Battery storage 0.5 MW · Backup power and load management

Solar and batteries can buffer peak demand and cover grid outages . They are listed in the model as optional future items , not in the base case .

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CHAPTER 4

Building the capex

About 1.26 million of investment per hub

Seven of every ten euros of a hub's investment go into charging and the grid connection .

Item	Model amount	How it is built
Superchargers	726,000	11 × (35,000 hardware + 25,000 installation) + 10% permitting and design
Charging cables	5,500	22 × 250
Grid connection	435,000	35,000 per charger installation + 50,000 permits ; 0.25 MW per charger
Parking	32,500	Design 2,500 , lighting , fencing and gate , CCTV 10,000 each
Housing fit-out	60,300	Sign 15,000 , internet 300 , furniture 18 staff × 2,500
Total investment	1,259,300	
Rental deposit	397,973	Cash out , not an expense
Total cash needed	1,657,273	

Where the numbers come from
Hardware : 30,000 to 40,000 per charger · Installation : 20,000 to 35,000 per unit · Charger site ballpark 0.5 to 0.8 million from a fast-charging operator

These are the ranges written next to each input in the model (assumptions) . The model flags that the network operator might bear charger costs ; that is not confirmed .

Depreciation in the model
Superchargers : 15 years , 10% residual · Leasehold and fit-out : 10 years , 10% residual · Computers : 5 years

Long lives on chargers keep the yearly cost of the largest item low .

Optional capex
Solar 0.5 MW : 1.9 million incl . installation and permits · Battery 0.5 MW : 425,000

Not in the base total .

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CHAPTER 5

Running costs and staffing

About 4,750 a day to run a 375-car hub

In the base model the biggest running costs are rent and people , not electricity , because energy is charged per car .

Activity	Per day	Main driver
Charging (staff + charger upkeep)	1,292	8 FTE at 15/hour , 24/7 shifts ; 1,000 per charger per year upkeep
Parking (monitoring)	16	15 cameras at 32.50 a month
Fleet management	813	4 staff at 25/hour + software
Housing	1,509	Rent at about 176 per m2 per year , cleaning , internet
Customer service	330	2 staff at 20/hour + software seats
Finance and admin	359	2 staff at 22/hour + ERP
Marketing	437	2 staff at 27/hour
Total	4,755	

Staffing
18 people in the model · Charging 24/7 : one night shift , two people per day shift · Social charges about 10% on top (assumption)

Staffing is one of the three key assumptions . The older , detailed scenario also includes cleaning crews , car washes , tyres and brake pads , which brings the cost per day far higher ; decide early which services your hub sells and which the fleet buys elsewhere .

Energy
15 kWh per 100 km · 0.40 per kWh (assumption)

Electricity per car follows directly from kilometres driven ; at 40% utilisation that is about 35 kWh per car per day in the model .

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CHAPTER 6

Financing a hub

Mostly debt , secured on the hardware

A hub is infrastructure : heavy upfront , long-lived , easy for a lender to understand .

> **The model's structure**
> 85% debt on the investment · 6% interest a year (assumption) · Repaid over 120 months · The rest equity , plus the rental deposit

Per hub , the model draws about 1.07 million of senior debt and repays it monthly over ten years . The rental deposit and the first months of running costs before cars arrive must come from equity .

> **What lenders will ask**
> A signed or optioned site · A grid connection offer and date · Charger quotes · A ramp plan for cars served per day

The grid connection is often the longest lead item ; bring proof of it early .

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CHAPTER 7

Step-by-step plan and timeline

About five months from keys to first car

The model opens the first hub in month one and phases people in as cars arrive .

Step	Timing in the model
Rent site , pay deposit , start marketing	Month 0
Order chargers , apply for grid connection	Month 0 (grid 4 to 6 months)
Hire finance and admin	Month 2
Hire fleet management and customer service	Month 4
Chargers live , charging staff start	Month 5 to 6
Add hubs as the fleet grows	Model ramp : 2 , 6 , 11 , 12 , 13 hubs over five years

Grow with the fleet
Model fleet : 750 cars on average in year one , 4,875 in year five · One hub per few hundred cars

Add a hub when the existing ones near their cars-per-day limit , not before .

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CHAPTER 8

Checklist

Before you sign a lease

Print this page .

Checklist
Cars served per day and target utilisation written down · Chargers sized : cars ÷ 36 charges per charger · Site of about 3,000 m2 , 10 km from the centre · Grid capacity of 0.25 MW per charger confirmed · Charger and installation quotes · Parking for redundant cars · Staffing plan for 24/7 charging · Cleaning service decided · Debt term sheet and equity for deposit and ramp · Insurance and permits

Change one assumption at a time and recheck the hardware and staff .

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